

Executive Summary:

The University of Virginia (UVA) receives about \$22 million in foreign funding, behind peer public research universities such as the University of Michigan and the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill. Though UVA has great funding pipelines through countries like Switzerland and Bermuda, it has not taken advantage of other large global markets that its peers have. The strategy that UVA should pursue is shifting its efforts toward high-yield donor nations like China, India, England, and Saudi Arabia, which could potentially add substantial funding to the University.

Initial Analysis:

When looking at the Foreign Gifts dataset, we found that the high majority of foreign funding to U.S. institutions come from fewer than 10 nations. Within this, UVA captures just over a tenth of a percent of the total foreign gifts market. When compared to its peers, UVA ranks third overall, with a little over 22 million dollars in total foreign gifts, outperforming Virginia Tech, but falling behind UNC-Chapel Hill and significantly behind University of Michigan. This is likely because UVA drafts from a narrow set of donor countries, mostly receiving from Switzerland and Bermuda, whereas its peers are pulling from more notable and larger nations.

Strategy:

The strategy that we believe would benefit UVA would be to start targeting the major donation countries where its peers have already seen much success from where UVA doesn't already receive engagement. Those countries should be China, India, Saudi Arabia, Canada, and Hong Kong. UVA has a strong network of Alumni that likely reside in these nations, and could maybe use those connections to gain contact with sources of funding.

Conclusion:

UVA has many prospects for increasing their foreign giving that would allow the university to tap into not yet reached markets. What makes this pursuit less difficult is that its very own peers have already established themselves in the nation pipelines, allowing UVA to not invent a new wheel, but take inspiration from what has already been done. By shifting its focus to these nations, UVA would have a great opportunity to secure a position as a globally recognized competitive research institution.